Buddhism also lost its royal patronage after Harshavardhana. In contrast, the Vedic religion got royal patronage first from Pushyamitra Sunga and later from imperial Guptas. The role of the exponents of Bhakti movement like Ramanuja, Ramananda also helped to restore the glory of Vedic religion.



Toramana Coins

The invasion of Huns gave a deathblow to Buddhism. Toramana and Mihirakula, the two Hun chiefs had a deep-seated hatred for the Buddhists and they almost liquidated the Buddhists living in the north-west India. To make matters worse, the Rajput rulers who could not reconcile to the Buddhist concept of non-violence, and as ardent advocates of Vedic religion started persecuting the Buddhists. Finally the invading Arabs and Turks forced the Buddhist monks to flee from India and seek asylum in Nepal, Tibet and Ceylon. In consequence Buddhism faded away in India.

SUMMARY

- Between 1000-700 BCE iron played a significant role in extending the area of cultivation.
- Agricultural surplus, growth of crafts, trade and the growing population led to the emergence of towns and exchange centres in the Gangetic plains.
- The Mahajanapadas are classified as gana-sangas and chiefdoms based on the nature of their polity.
- According to Ajivikas, gain and loss, joy and sorrow and life and death were the six inevitable factors of life.
- Mahavira's three principles and Buddha's eight fold path created a new intellectual awakening in India during the sixth century BCE.
- Influence of Jainism and Buddhism spread to Tamilnadu from about the third century BCE.

EXERCISE

6QE4C

I. Choose the correct answer

1. Buddha delivered his first sermon in _____
   (a) Sanchi (b) Benaras
   (c) Saranath (d) Lumbini
2. _____ is the Buddhist text that makes a reference to Ajatashatru's meeting of Buddha
   (a) Jivakasinthamani
   (b) Acharrangasutra
   (c) Kalpasutra
   (d) Samannapha Sutta
3. *Bhagavatisutra* is a _____ text
   (a) Buddhist (b) Jaina (c) Ajivika (d) Vedic
4. _____ played an important role in improving the method of cultivation.
   (a) Iron (b) Bronze (c) Copper (d) Brass
5. Among the 16 *mahajanapadas*, _____ emerged as the most powerful in northern India.
   (a) Kosala (b) Avanti (c) Magadha (d) Kuru

II. Write brief answers

1. Write the tripitakas that serve as the source for our study.
2. What do you know about Carvaka Philosophy?
3. Explain the core of Mahavir's teachings.
4. Distinguish the difference between janapadas and mahajanapadas.
5. Write the importance of Nagapattinam in the Buddhist history of Tamilnadu.

III. Write short answers

1. Write a note on the use of iron in clearing the forest critically.
2. Analyse the factors responsible for the rise of towns and cities in the Ganges Plains.
3. Mention some of the rising towns and cities in the aftermath of second urbanization.
4. Identify the heterodox thinkers of fifth and sixth century BCE.

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